HEMCHAND YADAV VISHWAVIDYALAYA, DURG (C.G.)

M. A. Previous – 2025-26

Paper-V

The History of English Literature

Max. Marks – 100
Min. Marks – 36

Unit-I

The Age of Chaucer (1350-1400)

1. Characteristic features of the age
2. Development of Poetry in the Age of Chaucer
3. Chaucer as the father of English Poetry
4. Development of Prose during the Age of Chaucer

The Age of Shakespeare (1558-1625)

1. The Renaissance and its influence on Elizabethan Literature
2. Salient literary trends of the age
3. University wits and their contribution to the Pre-Shakespearean Drama
4. Elizabethan sonnets and sonneteers
5. Development of English Prose during the latter half of the 16th century

Unit-II

The Age of Milton (1625-1660)

1. Literary characteristics of the age
2. The Puritan Movement in the Age of Milton
3. The Metaphysical Poetry and the poets
4. Cavalier poetry and the Cavalier poets
5. Development of Prose during the Age of Milton

The Restoration Period (1660-1700)

1. Social, Political and Literary tendencies of the Age.
2. Restoration Satire and Satirists
3. The comedy of manners and the dramatists of this school
4. English Novel in the latter half of the 17th Century

Unit-III

The Age of Pope (1700-1750)

1. Literary characteristics of the age
2. 18th Century as an age of Prose & Reason
3. The growth of the 'Periodical Essays' and the causes of its popularity
4. 'Coverley Papers' as the first sketch of the English Novel.

17/06/25 17-6-25 17/6/25

The Age of Transition/The Age of Dr. Johnson (1750-1798)

1. Salient features of the Poetry of the 'Romantic Revival'
2. The precursors of the 'Romantic Revival' or the poets of Revolt
3. The French Revolution and its influence on English literature
4. The 'Four Wheels' of the novel of the 18th Century

Unit-IV

The Age of Romanticism (1798-1832)

1. Characteristics of 'Romanticism'
2. Prose of the age of Romanticism
3. Novel of the age of Romanticism

The Victorian Age (1832-1887)

1. Salient features of Victorian Poetry
2. The Spasmodic School of Poetry
3. The Pre-Raphaelite Movement in English Poetry and its chief exponents
4. The Oxford Movement
5. Victorian novels and the novelists

Unit-V

The Modern Age/The Age of Interrogation (1890-1950)

1. General characteristics of the Age
2. Poetry;
    a. The Transitional poets (Robert Bridges, Hopkins, Yeats)
    b. The Georgian Poets
    c. The War Poets
    d. The Imagist Movement and its exponents
    e. The Neo-Metaphysical
3. The English Essays and the Essayists during the 20th Century
4. Drama in the 20th Century
    a. The Expressionistic School of Drama
    b. The Problem Play of the 20th Century
    c. The Poetic Drama and the Dramatists
    d. The Theatre of the Absurd
5. The Stream of Consciousness Novel

17-6-25 17/06/25 17-6-25 17.6.25 17/6/25 17/6/25.

DIRECTIVES FOR STUDENTS, FACULTY AND EXAMINERS

1. The Paper is divided into 5 units and each unit is compulsory.
2. Candidates will answer 5 essay type questions from Unit I to V one from each unit, carrying 16 marks each. (5x16 = 80)
3. The fifth question will comprise of 4 short notes (One from each Unit) out of which 2 are to be attempted. (10x2 = 20)
4. Essay type answers should not exceed 400 words and will carry 16 marks, short notes should be within the limit of 200 words and will carry 10 marks. (10x2 = 20)
5. All questions shall carry equal marks. (20x5 = 100)

Recommended Reading

1.	W.H. Husdon	:	An Outline History of English Literature
2.	Compton-Rickett	:	A History of English Literature
3.	Ifor Evans	:	A Short History of English Literature
4.	Edward Albert	:	A Short History of English Literature
5.	Emile Legouis	:	A Short History of English Literature
6.	Emile Legouis & Louis Cazamian	:	A History of English Literature
7.	B. Prasad	:	A Short History of English Poetry
8.	B.P. Bagchi	:	Pages From the History of English Literature

17/06/25

17-6-25